



Employee Document Expiry Tracking — User Guide

Technical name: `odomate_hr_documents` · Version 19.0.1.0.1 · Odoo 19 Community

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1. What this module does

It keeps one record per expiring employee document — a work permit, a driving licence, a first-aid certificate — and makes sure nobody discovers the expiry the week after it happened.

Three things happen automatically, once a day, in one scheduled run:

1. Any **Valid** document whose expiry date is now in the past becomes **Expired**.
2. Each **Valid** or **Expired** document is checked against its document type's chasing pattern. If today is a chase day, the employee gets an email and their manager gets a To-Do activity dated on the expiry date.
3. Drafts are never chased, never expired, and never emailed about.

Scans live in the standard Odoo chatter of each document — there is no separate file field and no separate storage model, so attachments, followers and the message history all behave exactly like everywhere else in Odoo.

2. Installation

1. Copy `odomate_hr_documents` into your addons path.
2. **Apps** → **Update Apps List**.





3. Search for Employee Document Expiry Tracking and click **Install**.

Dependencies `hr` and `mail` install automatically if they are not present.

This module does not grant any group to any user at install time. Odoo's `hr` module already grants the administrator **Officer: Manage all employees** (`hr.group_hr_manager`) natively when it is installed, which is what makes the **Document Types** menu visible to them.

3. Configuration

3.1 Document types — Employees → Employee Documents → Document Types

Visible to HR managers only. Each type carries two settings that decide when reminders fire:

Field	Meaning
Name	What the type is called, e.g. <code>Work permit</code> . Must be unique.
Chasing Pattern	One of the four patterns in section 5.
Reminder Days	The <code>N</code> used by the pattern. Hidden and ignored for <code>On the expiry date only</code> ; must be greater than zero for the other three.
Active	Uncheck to archive a type you no longer issue. Existing documents keep it.

The demo data ships six types covering all four patterns: `Work permit` (60 days, once before expiry), `First-aid certificate` (14 days, once before expiry), `Driving licence` (21 days, daily before), `Forklift certificate` (7 days, daily after), `Residence permit` (on expiry only) and `Professional licence` (30 days, once before expiry).

3.2 The scheduled action

Settings → Technical → Scheduled Actions → Employee Documents: expire and chase. It runs once a day and calls `odomate.hr.document._cron_process_documents()`. You can change the interval or run it manually from that screen; running it twice in one day will not send a second email, because each document stamps the date of its last automatic reminder.

4. Daily use

4.1 Recording a document

Employees → Employee Documents → Documents → New.

Fill in the employee, the document type, the issue date and the expiry date, then drag the scan into the chatter's attachment area at the bottom of the form. The **Reference** (`EMPDOC/00001`, `EMPDOC/00002`, ...) is assigned automatically and cannot be edited.

The record starts in **Draft**. A draft is deliberately inert: it is not chased, not expired, and does not block a second document of the same type. Use drafts for documents you are still waiting on.



Press **Mark Valid** when the paperwork is in hand. Two rules apply:

- If the expiry date is strictly before today, the transition is refused with an error telling you to use **Renew** instead. An expiry date of exactly today is accepted.
- An employee may hold only **one Valid document per document type**. A second one is refused, on create and on write, and the same rule is enforced by a partial unique index in the database, so two simultaneous imports cannot slip a duplicate through.

Draft and Expired copies of the same type may coexist freely — only Valid is exclusive.

4.2 Finding what needs attention

The **Documents** list colours expired rows red and bold, and greys out drafts, so a problem is visible without reading a single date. The **Days Remaining** column spells out the distance in words: `Expired 12 days`, `Today`, `Tomorrow`, or a plain number such as `43`.

Filters: **Valid**, **Expired**, **Draft**, **Expiring within 7 days**, **Expiring within 30 days**. Group by **Employee**, **Document Type**, **Status** or **Expiry Month**.

The two "expiring within" filters are translated into a plain date range on `date_expiry` behind the scenes, so they stay correct without any stored day-counter that could go stale overnight.

4.3 The employee's own view

Every internal user sees the **Documents** menu and finds their own documents there, read-only. They cannot see a colleague's document — not through the list, and not by opening its address directly.

4.4 From the employee form

The employee form carries a **Documents** smart button (HR officers and above) showing the count and opening that person's documents, with the employee pre-filled on the New button.

4.5 Chasing by hand

Send Reminder Now on the document form sends the reminder email and creates or refreshes the manager's To-Do immediately, whatever the chasing pattern says. It also stamps today's date, so that evening's scheduled run will not send a duplicate — but tomorrow's run is unaffected. The button is refused on a draft.

5. The chasing patterns, with worked examples

All four compare **today** with the document's **expiry date**. Assume a document expiring on **15 June** with **Reminder Days = 5**.

Pattern	Fires when	For our example
On the expiry date only	today = expiry	15 June only. <code>Reminder Days</code> is ignored.



Once, N days before expiry	$\text{today} = \text{expiry} - N$	10 June only. Nothing on 11–15 June.
Every day from N days before expiry until expiry	$\text{expiry} - N \leq \text{today} \leq \text{expiry}$	10, 11, 12, 13, 14 and 15 June — six sends.
Every day from expiry until N days after expiry	$\text{expiry} \leq \text{today} \leq \text{expiry} + N$	15, 16, 17, 18, 19 and 20 June — six sends.

Each fire does two things:

1. **Email to the employee**, using the Employee Document: Expiry Reminder template, addressed to the work email (falling back to the private email). No email address on file means no email — the run does not fail.
2. **A To-Do activity on the manager** (`employee_id.parent_id.user_id`), dated on the document's expiry date. If a To-Do from a previous run is still open, its deadline and summary are refreshed rather than a second one created. An employee with no manager on file gets the email only.

`Last Reminder Sent` (visible with developer mode on) is what stops a second automatic send on the same calendar day. It never suppresses the next day's send in a daily pattern.

6. Renewing a document

Renew is available on Valid and Expired documents — not on drafts.

The wizard asks for exactly four things: the new issue date, the new expiry date, one or more new scans, and a reason. It refuses to continue if:

- no scan is attached,
- the new expiry date is not strictly in the future, or
- the new expiry date is not strictly after the new issue date.

On success, in one step:

- the document's **current** issue and expiry dates are copied into a new **Renewal History** row, together with who renewed it, when, and why;
- the scans that were on the document are **re-pointed** to that history row — the same `ir.attachment` records, moved, not copied, so nothing is duplicated and nothing is lost;
- the new scans are attached to the document;
- the document takes the new dates and returns to **Valid**;
- a chatter note records `old expiry` → `new expiry` and the reason;
- any open manager To-Do is marked done with a completion note.

The **Renewals** smart button and the Renewal History page on the form show every past cycle:



renewal date, who did it, the superseded issue and expiry dates, the reason, and how many superseded scans that row holds. History rows are read-only in the interface — they are only ever written by the wizard.

Set to Draft (Valid or Expired → Draft) also closes any open manager To-Do, because the expiry date that To-Do was chasing no longer applies once the document is back to unverified.

7. Who can see and do what

	Documents	Renewal History	Document Types	Forms & Templates
Internal user (<code>base.group_user</code>)	read own only	read own only	read	read
HR Officer (<code>hr.group_hr_user</code>)	read / write / create, all employees	read, all	read	read / write / create
HR Manager (<code>hr.group_hr_manager</code>)	+ delete	+ delete	full	+ delete

Menu visibility: **Documents** and **Forms & Templates** are visible to every internal user; **Document Types** only to HR managers. The action buttons (**Mark Valid**, **Renew**, **Send Reminder Now**, **Set to Draft**) are hidden — not merely blocked — for users below HR Officer.

An internal user's read access is narrowed by a record rule to `employee_id.user_id = user.id`. Renewal history is narrowed the same way through `document_id.employee_id.user_id`.

A global multi-company rule (`[ '| ', ('company_id', '=', False), ('company_id', 'in', company_ids) ]`) applies to documents and to renewal history for everyone, including HR managers. `company_id` is derived from the employee, so it always matches the holder.

8. Forms & Templates

Employees → Employee Documents → Forms & Templates holds blank paperwork every employee can download: an expense claim form, a change-of-address notification, an equipment loan agreement. Name, a note explaining when to use it, and the file itself in the chatter. No dates, no status, no expiry chasing.

Everyone can read them; HR officers create and edit; HR managers delete.

9. Reference: models and fields

`ododate.hr.document.type`

`name`, `reminder_days`, `chasing_pattern` (`on_expiry` / `before_expiry` / `daily_before` / `daily_after`), `active`. Shared across all companies — one list for the whole database.

`ododate.hr.document`



reference, employee_id, document_type_id, description, date_issued, date_expiry, state (draft / valid / expired), company_id (related from the employee, stored), days_remaining_label (computed and searchable), last_reminder_sent_date, history_ids, history_count. Inherits mail.thread and mail.activity.mixin.

`ododate.hr.document.history`

document_id, employee_id, date_issued, date_expiry, renewed_by, renewed_date, reason, company_id, attachment_count.

`ododate.hr.form.template`

name, note, active. Inherits mail.thread.

`ododate.hr.document.renew (wizard)`

document_id, new_date_issued, new_date_expiry, new_attachment_ids, reason.

10. Limitations

Deliberately out of scope — do not expect these:

- **No approval workflow.** Marking a document valid is a single action by an HR officer; nobody countersigns it.
- **No blocking.** An expired document does not stop scheduling, payroll or leave. It raises a flag; acting on it is a human decision.
- **No employee self-service.** Employees can read their own documents but cannot upload a scan or start a renewal — HR does both.
- **No OCR.** Scans are stored as attachments; no data is extracted from them, so expiry dates are always typed in by hand.
- **No escalation ladder.** One email to the employee plus one To-Do for the direct manager. Nothing goes further up if both are ignored.
- **No printable report.** There is no PDF of the document register.
- **The standard hr fields are left alone.** `identification_id`, `passport_id` and `work_permit_expiration_date` on `hr.employee` are not read, written or superseded by this module — a document recorded here is a separate record from those fields, by design.
- **The daily pattern volume is real.** Every day from expiry until N days after expiry with `Reminder Days = 30` means thirty emails. Choose the reminder delay accordingly.
- **Reminders depend on the scheduled action running.** If the Odoo cron is disabled, nothing expires and nothing is chased.

